

# CAN COMPUTERS THINK?

The capability of today's computers is truly mind-boggling. Since the world's first electronic versions were turned on less than 100 years ago, computers have made rapid progress and now fulfill a range of functions. Though they may appear to think, computers can only perform tasks that they have been programmed to carry out. Computer behavior and responses cannot match the human brain's thought capacity and complexity . . . yet.

## TECHNOLOGICAL THOUGHT

### INNER THOUGHTS

Computers can be placed inside robots in an attempt to make them appear more human. Yet the unique inner thoughts experienced by individuals cannot be incorporated into a robot. If thoughts were entered as a program, these would come first from the programmer rather than the computer itself.

Who?

What?

Why?



### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

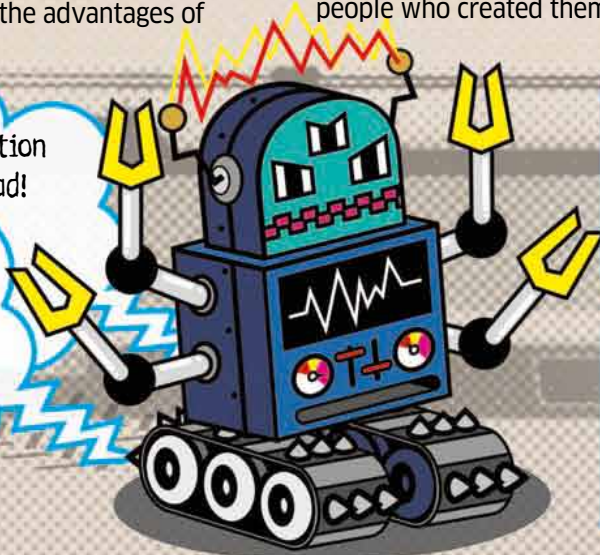
The ability of a computer or machine to perform activities that require thought is known as artificial intelligence. Some people dismiss the notion as irrelevant. After all, if a computer can do its job efficiently, why does it need to think, too? Computer scientists can see the advantages of

machines thinking as intelligently as people do. Although programmers strive to find ways of making machines more intelligent, not everyone is convinced. With ideas rooted in science-fiction movies and books, some fear that machines could become self-aware and rise up in rebellion against the people who created them.



Information overload!

Turn me off!  
I'm not in the mood.



### FEELINGS

Although it is possible to devise computer programs to imitate generic human thoughts, feelings are even more difficult to recreate. While computers can handle opening a variety of systems at once, they cannot mimic the range of emotions felt by people. Instead, they would have to be ordered (via new programs) to respond in certain ways to user actions.

Sob!